

13 Free Ways to Wrap Your Gifts with Style

Beautiful gift wrapping doesn't have to cost a fortune. You can easily find ways to wrap gifts with everyday items around the house. Not only will you save money, but people will also appreciate your thoughtfulness and creativity.

1. Use the Sunday comics section. Extra points for having a *Calvin and Hobbes* strip prominently displayed.
2. Leftover wallpaper or fabric from your home improvement projects can add a touch of class to any gift.
3. Hat and shoe boxes for sentimental gifts, especially mementos or keepsakes.
4. Spray-paint boxes with bright holiday colors. This works great for large gifts that already come in their own boxes.
5. For the rustic look, use craft or construction paper and dress up the package with twine, strings, sprigs of greenery, or pinecones.

6. Dress up any plain wrapping with stickers, stencils, and stamps.

Use things related to the gift

7. Use pages from magazines related to your gift. For example, *Vogue* for clothing, *Rolling Stone* for CDs, *National Geographic* for business travelers' gifts, *Wired* for gadgets, etc.
8. If you wrap anything with *The Onion*, the wrapping becomes a gift in itself.
9. Use old school dot-matrix printing paper for computer products.
10. Use maps for gifts related to traveling.

Use child labor

11. Children's drawings are great for gifts to relatives. Hey, it's about time your kids earn their keep.
12. Put children's handprints on white construction paper. Acrylic paint is usually the best choice for these projects. If you have a baby, little footprints would also work (Warning: this might be nauseatingly cute, and messy).
13. Have extra pictures of your kids lying around? Fold them in half and use them as gift or greeting cards. — **Will Chen**